Muhammad Qasim

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Professional Summary

Dynamic and results-oriented Network and Security Engineer with over seven years of experience delivering post-sales solutions, designing secure network architectures, and providing advanced support for network and security infrastructure. Specialized in FortiGate firewalls, F5 BIG-IP technologies, and Cisco security solutions, with 7 years of hands-on expertise in configuring and optimizing enterprise- grade security systems. Proficient in advanced firewall management, VPN implementations, intrusion detection/prevention, and threat mitigation across data center, security, and collaboration environments. Adept at deploying Juniper, Cisco, Fortinet, and F5 technologies to ensure high availability, scalability, and robust protection for enterprise networks.

- Expert in securing complex network infrastructures using FortiGate, F5, and Cisco technologies, focusing on advanced threat prevention and compliance.
- Proven ability to design and implement secure, scalable network solutions leveraging cutting-edge security protocols and technologies.

Core Competencies

Networking Technologies & Protocols

- **Bridging & Switching**:
  - VLANs, VTP, STP, MSTP, RSTP, Trunking, EtherChannel (Layer 3), Layer 2/3 switching.
- **Routing**:
  - OSPF, EIGRP, RIPv2, RIPng, OSPFv3, BGP (iBGP, eBGP), route redistribution, summarization, traffic engineering.
- **IP & IOS Features**:
  - IP addressing, DHCP, HSRP, NAT, NTP, SNMP, Virtual Chassis (VC) management.

Security Technologies

- **Firewall Management**:
  - FortiGate (FG600D, FG900D, FG1500D) with expertise in policy-based and application-layer filtering, deep packet inspection, and high-availability clustering; Palo Alto (PA5220) with Panorama management; Cisco ASA (ASA5500, ASA5545) with firepower services.
- **VPN Technologies**:
  - Designed and implemented IPSec, Cisco AnyConnect, DMVPN, Get VPN, and SSL VPNs, with advanced configurations for site-to-site and remote access VPNs, including FortiGate IPsec tunnels and F5 APM for secure application access.
- **F5 BIG-IP (5+ Years)**:
  - Expertise in Local Traffic Manager (LTM) for load balancing, Application Security Manager (ASM) for web application firewalls, Global Traffic Manager (GTM) for DNS load balancing, Link Controller (LC) for WAN optimization, and Access Policy Manager (APM) for secure access control.

- **Advanced Security**:
    - Next-gen firewalls (NGFW), zero-trust architecture, AAA (RADIUS/TACACS+), access control lists (ACLs), Cisco ISE for identity-based access, Infoblox for DNS/DHCP security,

  and FortiAnalyzer for centralized logging and analytics.

- **Hardware Expertise**
- **Routers**:
    - Cisco 2800, 2900, 3800; Juniper EX2200, EX4200, MX960, MX320.
- **Switches**:
    - Cisco 2960X, 3560X, 3750, 3850, 4500, 6500, 9300, 9200, 9500.
- **Firewalls**:
    - FortiGate FG600D, FG900D, FG1500D; Palo Alto PA5220; Juniper SRX210; Cisco ASA5500, ASA5545.

- **Other**: F5 BIG-IP, Cisco ISE, WSA, FMC, NGIPS.

Professional Certifications

- **Juniper Networks Certified Internet Expert (JNCIE) – Enterprise (License #702)**
- **Palo Alto Networks Certified Network Security Engineer (PCNSE)**
- **Cisco Certified Internetwork Expert (CCIE) – Routing & Switching (Written)**
- **Cisco Certified Internetwork Expert (CCIE) – Security (Written)**
- **VMware Certified Professional – Data Center Virtualization (VCP-DCV)**
- **Cisco Certified Specialist – Enterprise Advanced Infrastructure Implementation (ENCOR)**
- **Cisco Certified Specialist – Security Core**
- **Fortinet NSE 7 – Enterprise Firewall 6.2**

Education

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science 2014 – 2016
Virtual University of Pakistan

Diploma in Computer System Technician 2012 – 2014
Skills Professional College

Professional Experience

Senior Network and Security Engineer Procomme Technologies (Contracted to Armed Forces Hospital, Southern Region – AFHSR) Riyadh, Saudi Arabia
November 2022 – Present

- Manage end-to-end network and security infrastructure for 8,000+ users, leveraging Cisco (ASR, Nexus, UCS) and FortiGate firewalls (FG900D, FG600D, FG1500D).
- Design and implement advanced FortiGate security policies, including application-layer filtering, deep packet inspection, and IPsec VPN tunnels for secure remote access and site-to-site connectivity.
- Configure F5 BIG-IP modules (LTM, ASM, GTM, APM) to optimize load balancing, secure web applications, and enforce access policies for critical enterprise applications.
- Deploy Cisco ISE for identity-based access control and FortiAnalyzer for centralized logging, en- hancing threat visibility and compliance.

- Conduct penetration testing and vulnerability assessments using FortiGate NGIPS and Palo Alto threat prevention, mitigating advanced threats.
- Collaborate on IT security projects, manage change requests, and ensure compliance with zero-trust architecture standards.
- Provide second-level support for Cisco IOS/FortiOS upgrades and maintain security compliance protocols.

Senior Network and Security Engineer Advanced Electronics Company (AEC) (Contracted to AFHSR)
Riyadh, Saudi Arabia
August 2019 – November 2022

- Managed Cisco network infrastructure (ASR, Nexus, UCS) and FortiGate firewalls (FG900D) for 8,000 users, ensuring robust perimeter security.
- Configured FortiGate high-availability clusters and advanced security features, including SSL inspection, DoS protection, and intrusion prevention.
- Implemented F5 BIG-IP LTM and ASM for load balancing and web application firewall (WAF) protection, securing critical hospital applications.
- Integrated Cisco NGIPS and FortiGate NGIPS with SIEM tools for real-time threat detection and incident response.
- Supported Cisco wireless systems (WLC, WISM, ISR) and ensured secure connectivity for internet- facing environments.
- Coordinated IT planning, break/fix resolution, and change management for security and network operations.

Senior Network and Security Engineer Jersey for Computer & Communication Services (JCCS) (Contracted to AFHSR) Riyadh, Saudi Arabia
April 2019 – August 2019

- Administered Cisco infrastructure (ASR, Nexus, UCS) and FortiGate firewalls, focusing on secure network segmentation and policy enforcement.
- Configured F5 BIG-IP modules (LTM, ASM, LC, GTM, APM) for application delivery, security, and access control across enterprise systems.
- Deployed FortiGate IPsec and SSL VPNs, ensuring secure remote access for hospital staff and third- party vendors.
- Conducted security audits and implemented ACLs and AAA configurations using Cisco ISE and FortiGate.
- Collaborated on IT development and network management initiatives, ensuring alignment with security best practices.

Network Security Engineer Saudi Air Navigation Services (SANS) (Outsourced by Emircom Saudi Arabia)
Jeddah, Saudi Arabia
August 2018 – January 2019

- Designed and documented security standards for SANS head office, integrating FortiGate (FG1500D, FG600D) and Palo Alto (PA5220) firewalls.
- Configured FortiGate firewalls for advanced threat protection, including sandboxing, antivirus, and web filtering, with FortiAnalyzer for analytics.
- Implemented IPsec VPNs and traffic shaping policies on FortiGate to optimize network security and performance.

- Supported Cisco and Juniper routing/switching equipment, ensuring secure data center operations.
- Conducted firewall infrastructure reviews and provided remote support for security installations.

Senior Network Engineer Arabic Computer Systems (ACS)

Riyadh, Saudi Arabia December 2015 – August 2018

- Led Cisco and Juniper IP-networking projects, configuring Nexus, CAT, and Juniper EX series switches for secure network operations.
- Deployed FortiGate firewalls for initial security implementations, focusing on ACLs, VPNs, and traffic management.
- Supported F5 BIG-IP LTM for load balancing and basic application security configurations.
- Provided pre-sales and post-sales support for Cisco, Juniper, and Fortinet security solutions.

Network Administrator Habib Rafiq (Pvt.) Limited Pakistan

January 2014 – December 2015

- Designed and implemented IP addressing, subnetting, and routing protocols (RIP, OSPF, EIGRP) using Cisco infrastructure.
- Configured VLANs, NAT, and ACLs on Cisco switches to ensure network security and efficiency.

Network Engineer Intern (CCNA) Fast Communication Pvt. Ltd. Pakistan

May 2013 – December 2014

- Designed and implemented IP addressing, subnetting, and routing protocols (RIP, OSPF, EIGRP) on Cisco equipment.
- Configured Cisco routers (1800 series), switches, and hubs, supporting secure network infrastructure projects.

Personal Information

- **Nationality**: Pakistani
- **Languages**: English (Fluent), Urdu (Native)
- **Iqama Status**: Transferable